

Xunyao Xu

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

May 2026

BS, Finance & Data Science

- **GPA:** 3.79/4.0
- **Achievements:** Dean's List (2022–2024), Edmund J James Scholar (2022–2024), Derivatives and Trading Academy
- **Coursework:** Advanced Corporate Finance, Financial Markets, Investment & Portfolio Management, Data Analysis, Data Visualization, Modeling & Machine Learning, Vector Analysis, Algorithms & Data Structures

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

Futurus Vessel Capital Co., Ltd.

May 2025 - Aug 2025

Quantitative Researcher Intern (Remote)

Shanghai, China

- Processed millions of rows of daily A-share market data, including price-volume & fundamentals, using Python (Pandas, NumPy) for cleaning and feature engineering to support multi-factor model (Alpha factor) research.
- Researched and implemented predictive modeling using deep learning models (LSTM, Transformer) for time-series forecasting with high-frequency data.
- Utilized SQL and Excel VBA for data querying; developed 2 automation scripts to reduce daily preparation time by 1 hour.

Shenzhen Capital Group Co., Ltd.

Mar 2024 - Jul 2024

Quantitative Analysis Assistant Intern

Shenzhen, China

- Developed and backtested futures pricing & portfolio strategies using ML models (ARIMA, XGBoost) in R and Power BI, achieving a 1.5 Sharpe ratio.
- Enhanced trading system efficiency by integrating AI-driven analytics algorithms, boosting order execution rate by 20%.
- Created the “3C Strategy” for options trading, increasing predicted price rise probability to 80%.
- Automated data extraction and cleaning with Python and R scripts, cutting research time by 35%.
- Analyzed futures data from CFFEX and SHFE to optimize strategies via lag-day analysis.

Zhejiang Mintai Commercial Bank Co., Ltd

Jun 2023 - Aug 2023

Data Analysis Intern

Hangzhou, China

- Automated financial and operational data analysis using Python, improving reporting efficiency by 50%.
- Led a trainee team in market trend analysis and business modeling to support sales growth initiatives.
- Conducted branch operation research and reported findings to headquarters to aid decision-making.
- Streamlined cross-branch employee performance tracking using Excel VLOOKUP for 30 branches.
- Developed a Python program to process large-scale employee qualification data.

RESEARCH & PROJECTS

AI Mentor Development Project

Nov 2024 - Present

iVenture Accelerator, UIUC

- Analyzed 500+ anonymized student records to identify academic challenges and trends for ML model training.
- Integrated datasets from university resources, online platforms, and career services into AI training.
- Conducted bi-weekly evaluations of ML models, including NLP, to improve recommendation accuracy.
- Delivered monthly reports with actionable insights to guide project development.

Applied Quantitative Strategy Research in Financial Derivatives

Mar 2025 - Present

Derivatives and Trading Academy, UIUC

- Selected for the inaugural cohort of a hands-on program focused on trading, derivatives, and quantitative finance.
- Utilized exotic options and volatility forecasting in simulated trading; backtested strategies with proprietary code.
- Mentored junior cohort members on quantitative methodologies and practical applications of derivatives trading.
- Developed and validated data-driven trading strategies through quantitative research and performance analysis.

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

James Scholar Conference, Sleeman Leadership Institute, UIUC

Feb 2023 - Present

Participant

- Participated in problem-solving and teamwork workshops, strengthening leadership and decision-making skills.
- Networked with 50+ students and professionals to build academic and career connections.

James Scholar Volunteer

Sep 2022 - Present

Volunteer

- Prepared and distributed meals weekly for homeless communities through local church initiatives.
- Assisted in coordinating volunteer schedules and resource allocation for 4 community programs.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

- **Programming Languages:** Python, Java, R, SQL, MATLAB
- **Data Analysis & Modeling:** Predictive Modeling, AI-driven Analytics
- **Reporting & Visualization Tools:** Tableau, Power BI, Excel/VBA